

VISUAL ARTS

OVERVIEW

Visual arts courses at the Grade 11 and 12 level focus on studio work and critical analysis of a wide range of art works. Students apply the elements and principles of design with increasing skill and creativity to produce art works that communicate emotions or comment on issues. They apply their skills using an array of media, including alternative media, and current technologies, to create two- and three-dimensional art works for a variety of purposes.

Students create increasingly complex art works that integrate the fundamental components of design known as elements (colour, form, line, shape, space, texture, and value). Students continue to explore design principles (balance, contrast, emphasis, harmony, movement, proportion, rhythm and repetition, unity, and variety), organizing or arranging these principles in increasingly sophisticated ways to produce visual effects.

Students develop their understanding of how art works reflect and affect the history, values, and beliefs of various societies and cultures. By experiencing a wide range of art works, including the rich heritage of Canadian art, students enhance their understanding and appreciation of the range and significance of artistic expression.

The expectations for visual arts courses are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students enhance their ability to apply the creative process (see pages 15–17) to create and present original art works. Students use tools, technologies, and the elements and principles of design with increasing sophistication to create art works for a variety of purposes. Throughout, they document their approach to each stage of the creative process in a portfolio, which they can use for reflection.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** Through the critical analysis process (see pages 17–22), students reflect on their responses to and assess art works, developing a deeper understanding of themselves and the communities in which they live. By exploring the context of various art works, students expand their awareness of past and present societies. They explore opportunities for continuing engagement in postsecondary study and careers of personal interest in arts-related fields.
3. ***Foundations:*** In this strand, students enhance their understanding of conventions, techniques, and processes that people use to produce visual art works. Students refine their specialized vocabulary, engage in responsible practices when creating and presenting art works, and investigate increasingly complex ethical and legal issues associated with visual arts.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.
The list of approved focus courses for Visual Arts can be found at:
www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Visual Arts, Grade 11

Open

AVI30

This course focuses on studio activities in one or more of the visual arts, including drawing, painting, sculpture, photography, printmaking, collage, and/or multimedia art. Students will use the creative process to create art works that reflect a wide range of subjects and will evaluate works using the critical analysis process. Students will also explore works of art within a personal, contemporary, historical, and cultural context.

Prerequisite: None

A. CREATING AND PRESENTING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** apply the creative process to create a variety of art works, individually and/or collaboratively;
- A2. The Elements and Principles of Design:** apply elements and principles of design to create art works for the purpose of self-expression and to communicate ideas, information, and/or messages;
- A3. Production and Presentation:** produce art works, using a variety of media/materials and traditional and/or emerging technologies, tools, and techniques, and demonstrate an understanding of a variety of ways of presenting their works and the works of others.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use a variety of strategies, individually and/or collaboratively, to generate and explore ideas and to develop plans for the creation of art works (*e.g., use brainstorming, research, and/or checklists to generate and explore a range of original ideas; reflect on and filter ideas to select a suitable one to serve as the basis for their art work; use diagrams, notes, and/or outlines to help them develop detailed plans that reflect the stages of the creative process; reflect on and revise their plans on the basis of peer- and self-assessment*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways do external factors and personal experience influence the creative ideas we generate?” “Does your plan clearly address how you will approach each stage of the creative process?”

- A1.2** apply the appropriate stages of the creative process to produce two- and three-dimensional art works using a variety of traditional and contemporary media (*e.g., explore various media and techniques, and determine which ones are most appropriate for their planned art work; reflect on their work at each stage of the creative process; use a variety of strategies to gather feedback on their preliminary work, and refine their work on the basis of feedback and self-assessment*)

Teacher prompts: “How can you apply the results of your experiments with media to enhance the creativity of your work?” “Why are reflection and revision crucial to the planning and production of your art work?”

- A1.3** document their use of each stage of the creative process in a portfolio (*e.g., include notes, checklists, rough sketches, preliminary versions, and final products to provide evidence of planning, exploration, experimentation, production, reflection, and revision*), and refer to this portfolio to reflect on how effectively they have used the creative process

Teacher prompts: “How does your portfolio provide evidence of the informed development of original ideas?” “What might you add to your portfolio to document your experiments with different media?” “After reviewing your use of the creative process, how would you improve your approach to the planning or production stages?”

A2. The Elements and Principles of Design

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** use a combination of elements and principles of design to create art works that express personal feelings and communicate specific emotions to an audience (*e.g., use colour and line to suggest strong emotion; use harmony and unity to convey a sense of balance and peace*)

Teacher prompts: “How can you manipulate the elements of value, form, and balance to communicate fear or anger?” “How does Emily Carr communicate emotion through her use of elements and principles in *Vanquished*? How could you adapt her approach for use in one of your art works?”

A2.2 apply elements and principles of design as well as art-making conventions to create a variety of art works that explore and/or present a point of view on contemporary social issues and/or themes (*e.g., use line, form, and contrast as well as imagery and symbols associated with an urban subculture in a drawing or mixed-media work that explores the issue of discrimination*)

Teacher prompt: “Why is the imagery you have chosen appropriate for the subject matter of your work?”

A3. Production and Presentation

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 explore a range of techniques, tools, materials/media, and technologies, including alternative media and current technologies, and apply them to create and present a variety of art works (*e.g., use digital photographs, image-editing software, found objects, and fabric to create an original work of art; create site-specific art works, mosaics, plaster works; present their art work in a virtual gallery*)

Teacher prompts: “What techniques or media/materials could you combine to create a work that explores a social issue?” “What considerations must you address when creating an art work for display on the web?” “How can you engage your audience when working in a virtual environment? How can you use

the technology to enhance your audience’s interaction with your work?”

A3.2 demonstrate appropriate ways to prepare their art works for presentation in a variety of contexts or venues (*e.g., the conventions for presentation in a classroom compared to those in a community gallery, in a virtual gallery, or as part of a thematic exhibition in a cultural centre*)

Teacher prompts: “In completing this art work, how have you ensured that it is ready for display? Is it labelled, signed, matted, and/or mounted?” “Would you prepare your work differently if it were being displayed in a cultural centre rather than a classroom? Why or why not?”

A3.3 demonstrate an understanding of a variety of ways in which art works can be presented to reach a variety of audiences (*e.g., young children, youth who are no longer in school, members of a particular cultural group*) and to suit a range of purposes (*e.g., to engender debate, to inform, to entertain, to sell products*)

Teacher prompts: “What impact can the purpose of an art exhibition or installation piece have on choice of venue and on the number and type of people who see the exhibition or installation?” “Why can the use of public space be an effective way of getting an artist’s message out to a wide audience?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** demonstrate an understanding of the critical analysis process by examining, interpreting, evaluating, and reflecting on various art works;
- B2. Art, Society, and Values:** demonstrate an understanding of how art works reflect the society in which they were created, and of how they can affect personal values;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of the types of knowledge and skills developed in visual arts, and describe various opportunities related to visual arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** describe their initial reactions to a variety of art works (*e.g., their initial impressions of a work's mood, subject, intent, purpose, meaning*), and explain the reason for their reactions
Teacher prompt: "What is your initial impression of the meaning and purpose of Louise Bourgeois's *Maman*? What aspects of the work support this impression?"
- B1.2** identify and describe the elements and principles of design used in their own art works and the works of others, and explain how they are used to achieve specific effects (*e.g., determine how the artist has combined individual elements and principles to create mood and meaning*)
Teacher prompts: "How has the photographer used line, space, and balance to create a sense of movement in this photograph?" "How do the sculptures of Alberto Giacometti and Henry Moore differ in terms of the artists' use of line, shape, and form?" "In this car advertisement, how has the designer used colour, space, movement, and emphasis to highlight the selling points of the product?"
- B1.3** communicate their understanding of the meanings of a variety of historical and contemporary art works, based on their interpretation

of the works and an investigation of their historical and/or social context (*e.g., Haida masks or totem poles; the AIDS Quilt Project; J. M. W. Turner's The Slave Ship*)

Teacher prompt: "How has your understanding of Turner's painting changed as a result of your research into the historical context in which it was created?"

- B1.4** use a variety of strategies (*e.g., peer- and self-assessment, formal critiques, ongoing review and revision, feedback received from public displays*) to identify and reflect on the qualities of their own art works and the works of others, and evaluate the effectiveness of these works

Teacher prompt: "In what ways were you successful in communicating your message in your work? What would you change about this work if you could do it again?"

B2. Art, Society, and Values

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** explain the functions of various types of art works (*e.g., animation; various types of architecture; propaganda, public, and religious art; works focused on personal expression; satirical works*) in past and present societies
Teacher prompt: "What pieces of public art are there in your community? What is their purpose?"

B2.2 identify and explain ways in which various art works are a response to and a reflection of the society in which they were created (e.g., *how artists are influenced by their access to technology and materials and by social and/or political conditions*)

Teacher prompts: “What impact did the invention of paint tubes have on the development of impressionist landscape painting?” “Describe how a current technology has affected the way images are made.” “How has the invention of the camera and photocopier (lens-based art) affected the type of subject matter chosen by artists?” “What social issues did Keith Haring address in his work?”

B2.3 describe how creating and analysing art works has affected their personal identity and values and/or changed their perception of society (e.g., *with reference to their emotional awareness, their ability to express themselves, their approach to fashion, their cultural sensitivity, their awareness of stereotypes, their relationship with the physical environment, their appreciation of objects associated with cultural groups, their social awareness*)

Teacher prompt: “Which of the art works that you have studied has had the greatest impact on you? Why? What effect did the work have on your beliefs or perceptions related to the subject matter of the work?”

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 explain how knowledge and skills acquired in visual arts (e.g., *knowledge related to visual literacy; creative thinking and problem-solving skills; skills related to visual communication, spatial organization, and presentation; interpersonal*

skills developed through collaboration) could be applied in a wide variety of careers and in areas of future study

Teacher prompt: “Which skills have you acquired in visual arts that would contribute to your leadership potential in a career outside the arts? Explain how you could use these skills.”

B3.2 describe, on the basis of research, a variety of pathways and careers related to visual arts (e.g., *apprenticeships; postsecondary art programs; art-related careers in advertising, animation, architecture, art therapy, fashion design, filmmaking, gallery curation, graphic design, industrial design, photojournalism*) and the education required for these careers

Teacher prompts: “What types of courses would you have to take to pursue a career in graphic design?” “Would you need a university degree to become an architect?” “What types of apprenticeships or experiential learning are available for someone who wants to be an animator or filmmaker?”

B3.3 describe, on the basis of research, a variety of personal opportunities in their community in cultural or other fields related to visual arts (e.g., *opportunities to organize or assist with craft classes for younger children in the community, to design and produce decorations for an event associated with a cultural practice, to paint community murals, to design the school yearbook, to design and produce posters for a community event*)

Teacher prompt: “Are there local community centres that offer art or craft classes for children? How might you be able to assist the centre or the instructor?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, elements, principles, and other components related to visual arts;
- C2. Conventions and Techniques:** demonstrate an understanding of conventions and techniques used in the creation of visual art works;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of responsible practices related to visual arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** demonstrate an understanding of the elements and principles of design, and use appropriate terminology related to elements and principles when creating and analysing art works (*e.g., when explaining how a designer has used particular elements and principles to draw attention to a product in an advertisement*)
- C1.2** explain terminology related to techniques, materials, and tools, and use this terminology appropriately when creating and presenting art works (*e.g., techniques and tools from various cultures [East Asian, East and West African] used in textile design; silkscreening; stencilling; washes; type fonts*)
- C1.3** identify and describe the stages of the creative process and the critical analysis process using appropriate terminology, and explain how these processes are used to create and analyse art works (*e.g., the stages of the creative process used to make a print; the stages of the critical analysis process a gallery owner would use to evaluate the print*)

C2. Conventions and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** demonstrate an understanding of a wide variety of techniques that artists use to achieve specific effects (*e.g., the use of depth and angle in an engraving to convey a sense of movement*)

Teacher prompts: “What techniques have Japanese artists used to create woodblock prints? What effects can be achieved using these techniques?” “What techniques do installation artists use to get the attention of the viewer?”

- C2.2** demonstrate an understanding of a variety of conventions used in visual arts (*e.g., exaggeration, juxtaposition, metaphor, simile, symbols, synectics; conventions associated with heroic, narrative, naturalistic, and satirical art works; conventions associated with imitationalism*)

Teacher prompt: “What are some examples of the effective use of exaggeration in comics or graphic novels to provide social commentary?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

- C3.1** describe legal and ethical issues associated with the use of images, materials, and property (both physical and virtual) in the production of art works (*e.g., copyright; ownership of virtual and intellectual property; issues associated with cultural appropriation*), and demonstrate legal and ethical practices when creating, presenting, and/or promoting art works (*e.g., use accepted citation conventions when crediting other people's work; download images from authorized sources*)

Teacher prompts: “Why is it inappropriate to incorporate a corporate logo or copyrighted character into your design without getting permission to do so?” “What ethical issues have you encountered with respect to appropriation in visual art? How have you addressed these issues?”

C3.2 demonstrate an understanding of safe and conscientious practices associated with the use of materials, property, tools, and technologies in visual arts, and apply these practices when creating and/or presenting art works (*e.g., take appropriate precautions when working with hazardous materials; adopt protective measures when working with sharp or heavy tools; keep their work space tidy and free of physical and other hazards; demonstrate respect for physical property, classroom facilities, tools, and technological devices*)

Teacher prompt: “Why is it important to apply safe practices when handling art materials? What should you do if you don’t know whether a material is toxic?”

C3.3 demonstrate an understanding of how the production and presentation of art works can affect the environment, and apply environmentally responsible practices when creating, presenting, and promoting art works (*e.g., use recycled materials and those made from sustainable resources when creating their works and when packing and shipping art works; dispose of waste materials, including hazardous materials, in an environmentally responsible way; reduce the use of paper by using email and the Internet to promote an exhibition*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some of the ways you could use found materials responsibly in the creation of an assemblage?” “What are some alternatives to styrofoam packaging?” “How can creating art works be harmful to the environment? What are some ways of ensuring that you are an environmentally friendly artist?”